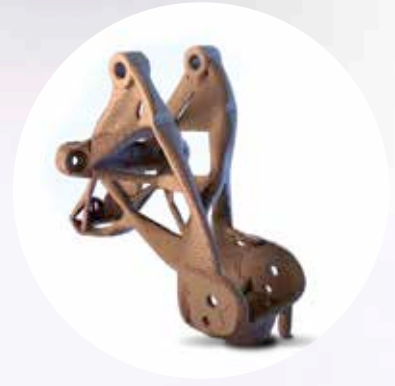
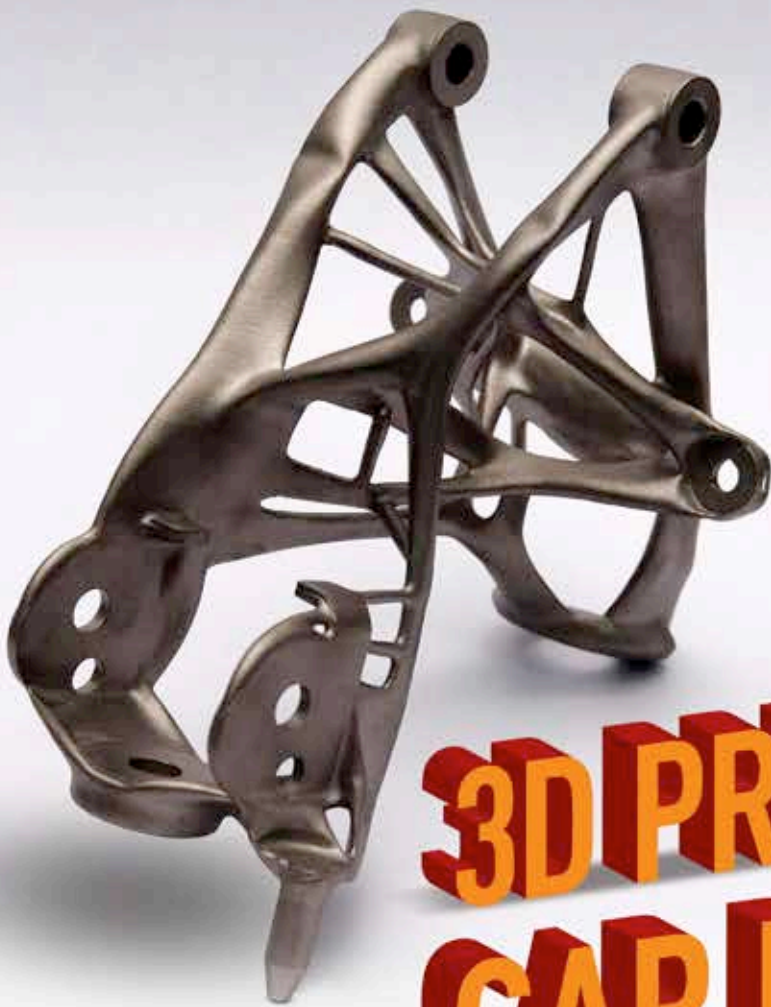




The 3D printed seat bracket

3D PRINTING CAR PARTS

The Birth of an Industry?

General Motors is eyeing 3D printing as a way to increase efficiency in EVs - here's how it would work.

Souvik Das | souvik@digit.in

3D printing automobile components

3D printing has found widespread application in core professional fields, and researchers across the world are making the full use of the diverse abilities of 3D printing to experiment with objects and components. At the moment, 3D printing is being used by aviation and aeronautics industries to build lightweight parts out of composite material, which are both lighter

than conventional material and are specially synthesised to be stronger than what was already available.

Ken Kelzer, VP of GM's Global Vehicle Components and Subsystems, stated earlier this month, "This disruptive technology provides tremendous advancements in how we can design and develop components for our future vehicles to make them lighter and more efficient. When we pair the design technology with

If you have ever followed the world of motorsport and rallying, you will have seen how cars made for the track are stripped down to the bare minimum, often not featuring elements that we really take for granted usually. Racers often remove elements like additional seats, any stereo/air conditioning, and even strip out regular parts in favour of specialised, lightweight ones. The reason for this is fairly simple - a lighter car is certain to be faster and will offer a longer range with a full tank of fuel.

It is this principle that General Motors (GM) is applying to everyday cars, in order to streamline production procedures, raise profitability and increase efficiency of cars. In a release talking about the new technology on its website, GM touched upon the usage of industry-grade 3D printing along with advanced software-based design technologies as the latest move in the field of vehicle lightweighting. To bring this concept into reality, General Motors has teamed up with software design giant Autodesk.